Published on: May 30th, 2026

Market Briefs Pro

Read Less News

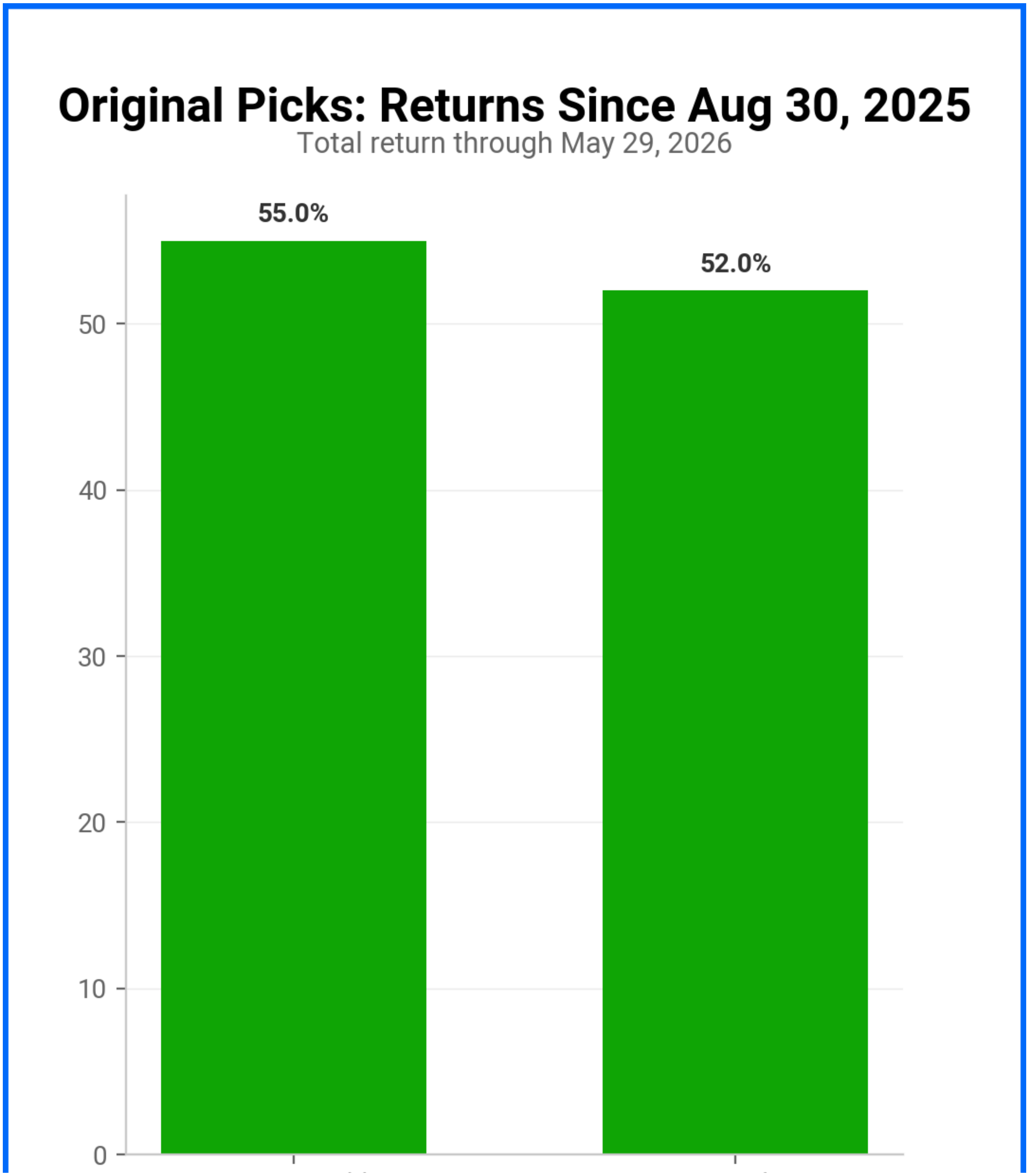
**Good morning, Pro Briefers!**

On August 30, 2025, we identified a Wall Street Shift: Smart money wasn't moving into gold as a commodity - it was moving into the companies digging it out of the ground.

The opportunities we identified? As of May 29th, 2026, they are all winning.

Kinross Gold (KGC) has jumped 55% over that timeframe and Barrick (B) is up 52%.

After we published, gold went on a bull run.



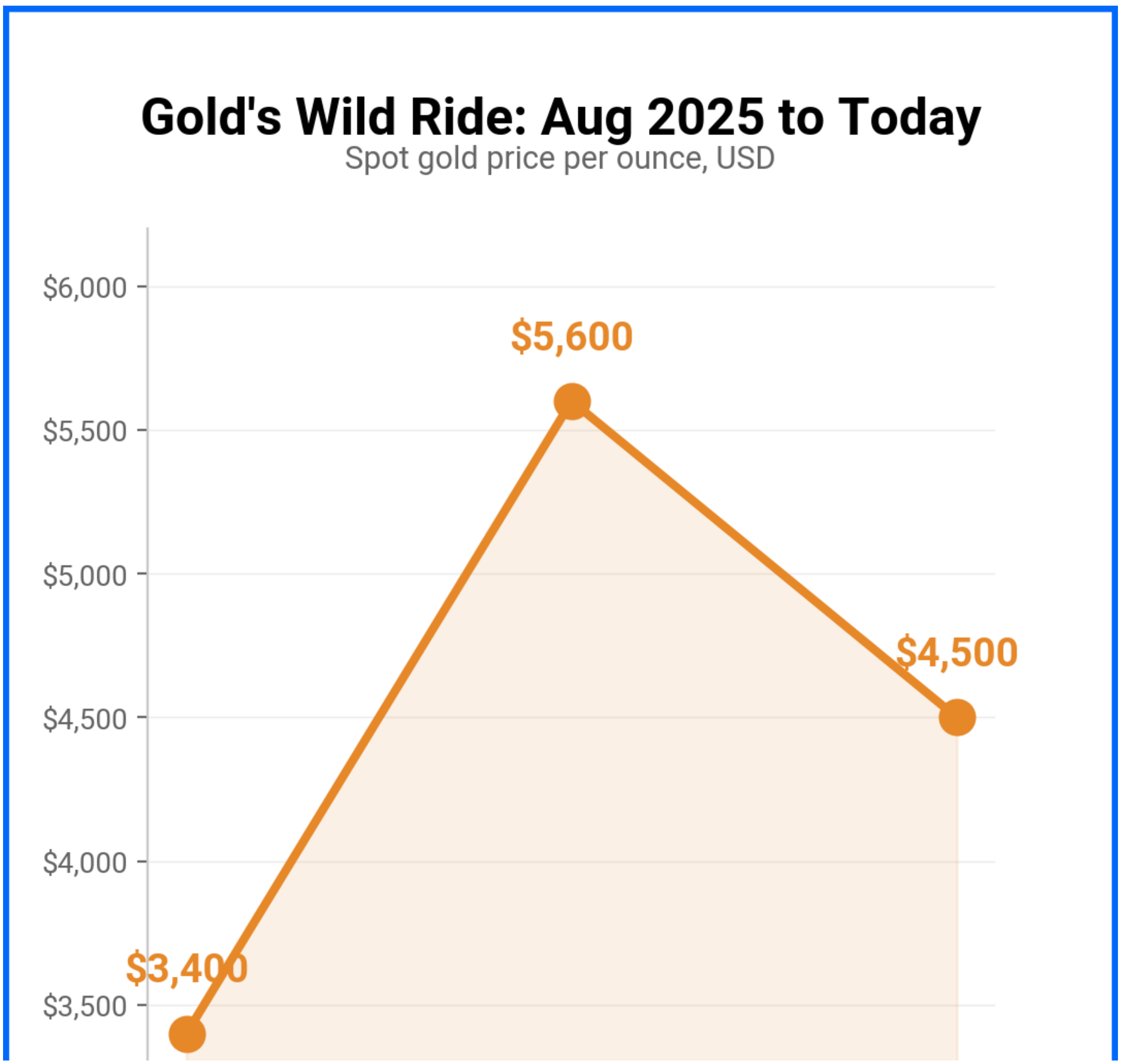

*Data via Briefs Terminal*

It climbed from around $3,400 an ounce to nearly $5,600 by late January 2026 - the first time ever it topped its old 1980 record once you account for inflation.

Gold miners jumped too - as their costs don't really rise when they mine more gold, but their margins typically get more positive.

But recently, gold has slipped from its record high.

Gold now trades near $4,500, and the mining stocks have handed back 22-30% from their highs.




**Market Briefs Pro**

So here's what's on every subscriber's mind: is the chance gone, or has it come back around?

That’s exactly why we wanted to update you on this opportunity - and the short answer is: We believe the gold trade is coming back around.

And smart money isn’t going anywhere.

So today we're refreshing a Wall Street Shift we've tracked for nine months:

Big institutions - banks, governments, and pension funds - keep loading up on gold, and that's funneling profits straight into the miners.

Let's briefly break down what’s happening, then get straight to the names we're watching now.

---

### *ANALYST TAKE*

Tickers we're tracking:

**High margin:** KGC

**Low cost miner:** NEM

**The copper hedge:** B

**The premium play:** AEM

**ETFs:** RING, SGDM, GDXJ

---

# Digging For Gold

A falling price feels scary, but the reason behind it matters far more than the drop.

Here's a quick timeline for context:

**February 27:** Gold ETFs - funds that hold gold so investors can buy it like a stock - were sitting on more of the metal than ever, a record 4,176 tonnes.

**February 28:** The U.S., Israel, and Iran went to war.

**Mid-March:** investors pulled a record $12 billion out of those funds.

Meanwhile, the case for gold only got stronger.

## The Three Pillars Still Standing

**Governments keep buying — central banks added 244 tonnes in early 2026, and 68% say they plan to buy more.**

**The dollar keeps sliding — U.S. debt interest set to double by 2036, and 30-year yields hit 5.2% in May.**

**Miners keep minting money — gold outruns their costs, with Kinross**

**booking a record $3,476 profit per ounce.**

**Market Briefs Pro**

- Central banks bought another 244 tonnes early in 2026, their busiest buying stretch in more than a year, and 68% say they plan to buy even more.

- The U.S. keeps spending far more than it earns, with the interest on its debt set to double by 2036.

- And the rate on 30-year government bonds hit 5.2% in May, the highest since 2007 - normally a headwind for gold, except that old link has snapped. Gold is climbing even with rates this high.

Gold typically rises during times of economic stress, as it has kept its value when inflation rises or if we see a market downturn.

Central banks bought up gold because the dip created an opportunity - retail investors sold out of emotion.

Here's why that lifts the miners most. The cost to dig up gold stays fairly steady, but the selling price can leap, and the gap in between is pure profit.

Kinross just booked a record $3,476 of profit per ounce, close to double a year earlier - even though its costs rose about 40%. Gold simply ran faster.

The bottom line: War and other matters are scaring off the market, but the Wall Street Shift we identified with gold miners is still going strong.

But that creates an even stronger buying opportunity - because prices are not low because the companies are in trouble, they’re low because the market is uneasy.

Let’s break down the potential investment opportunities we’re watching right now.

---

*HIGH MARGIN*

# The Margin Machine

Kinross has been outperforming since our last report, and it's still the one with the most horsepower.

Here’s a fresh update:

It dug up 490,000 ounces early in 2026, beating Wall Street's target, and its adjusted profit of $0.19 a share topped the $0.15 analysts expected.

- For the full year, it's aiming for about 2 million ounces.

**The trade-off:** Kinross tends to be more volatile than other gold miners.

## Kinross (KGC): Record Margins

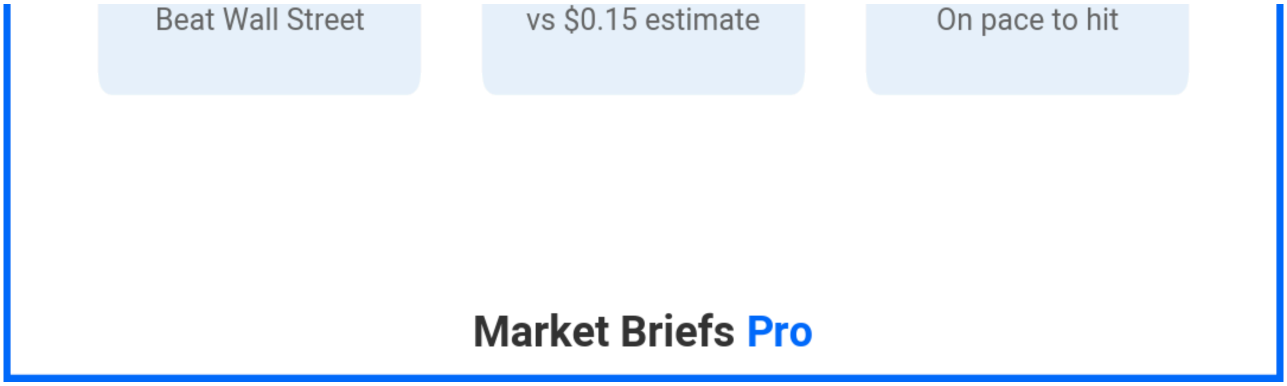
Q1 2026 — beats Wall Street on every line

**Profit per Ounce**

**$3,476**

≈ 2x prior year, even as costs rose ~40%

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **490K** | **$0.19** | **~2M** |
| oz produced (Q1 2026) | adjusted EPS | oz full-year target |



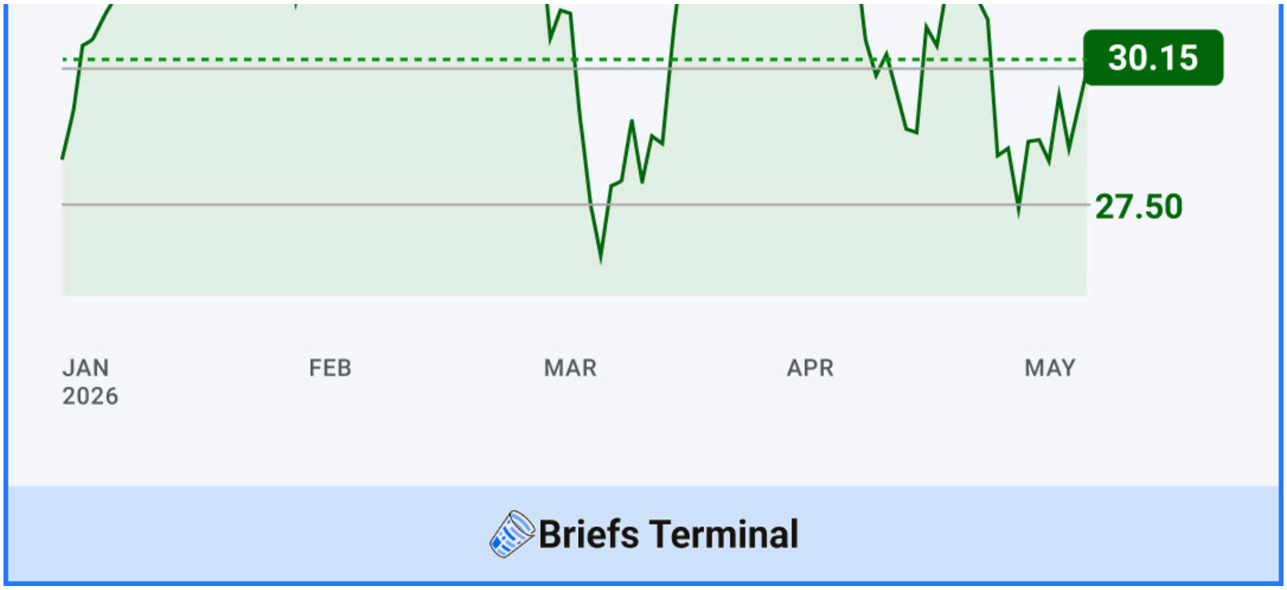

*Data via Kinross Investor Presentation*

Wall Street measures this with beta - how much a stock moves compared to the market - and Kinross runs roughly 40% hotter in both directions.

- That means bigger gains when gold rises, and bigger drops when it dips.

With that said, trimming a bit of profits from Kinross now while gold is volatile could be an opportunity.

The Shift is still at play here - but while the market is volatile, Kinross will be too.




*Data via Briefs Terminal*

**Exit Trigger:** If Kinross's cost-per-ounce keeps rising while gold flattens, its gains will be limited.

That could give an edge to other bigger miners who are selling gold cheaper.

---

***LOW COST MINER***

# Keeping Costs Low

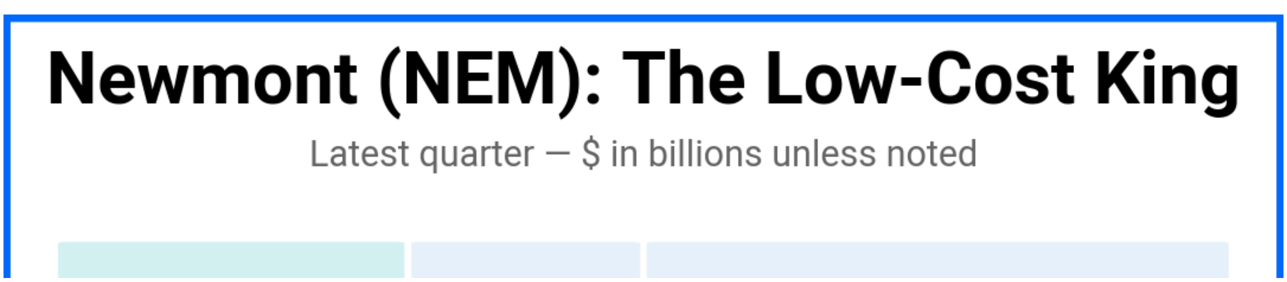
Newmont (NEM) is the big addition to our updated list.

**Why now?** Because it's the cheapest digger in the business.

Newmont is the world’s largest gold mining company. And while it does mine other resources like silver and zinc, 85% of its revenue comes from gold.

It costs Newmont just $1,029 to pull up an ounce of gold - roughly 40% below the industry average.

Lower costs = bigger profits.



| Metric | Value | Context |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Cost per oz | $1,029 | ~40% below industry avg |
| Avg selling price | $4,900 | Per ounce sold |
| Profit per oz | $3,900 | Fattest margin of any major |
| 2026 production | 5.3M oz | ~2.5x Kinross output |
| Quarterly revenue | $7.3B | — |
| Quarterly profit | $3.3B | 45% net margin |
| Free cash flow | $3.1B | Record for a single quarter |
| New buyback | $6.0B | On top of $6B already done |
| Gold share of rev. | 85% | + silver, copper kicker |

Market Briefs Pro

*Data via Newmont Investor Presentation*

**Why so cheap?** Newmont bought a big rival, Newcrest, back in late 2023, which has led to major savings.

- It sold its gold for about $4,900 an ounce last quarter, which works out to nearly $3,900 of profit on each one - the fattest margin of any major miner.

Newmont also plans on pulling up about 5.3 million ounces this year, more than double

Kinross.

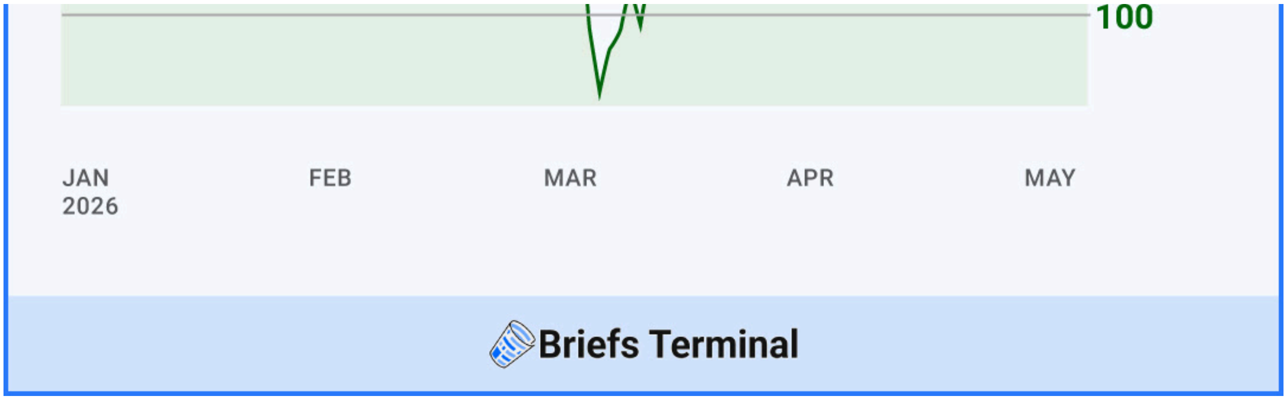
That scale allowed it to generate a record $3.1 billion in spare cash in a single quarter and $3.3 billion in profit on $7.3 billion in sales.

That spare cash can now be used for more acquisitions or just be held onto in case the market gets shaky.

On top of that, it just announced a fresh $6 billion plan to buy back its own shares - and that's after already finishing $6 billion in buybacks.

- Share buybacks can increase shareholder value by reducing the number of shares available, which can increase a company's earnings per share.

Newmont also scoops up copper and silver as it mines - it's now the planet's third-biggest silver miner - which gives it extra income that pure gold names don't have.




*Data via Briefs Terminal*

**One thing to know:** A new tax in Ghana will bump its costs up a touch this year, but it still keeps the low-cost crown.

**Exit Trigger:** Newmont is producing a lot of gold at scale. That means it needs to keep its costs low for this opportunity to earn meaningful returns.

If it ever loses its low-cost lead to rivals, its main advantage goes with it.

---

***TWO MORE MOVES***

# Double Gold Spotlight

Speaking of costs dropping, Barrick has actually seen its costs go down recently too.

Its costs to mine gold are now down 4% year over year - profits jumped 238%, it's buying back $3 billion in shares, and it pays a small dividend.

This is running at a time when gold has taken a hit - further indicating that worried money is leaving, but smart money is staying.

Barrick also mines a lot of copper, which experts believe is heading toward a global shortage - a handy bonus if gold ever cools off.

## Gold Miner Showdown

Latest quarter — Kinross, Newmont, Barrick, Agnico Eagle

| Metric | Kinross (KGC) | Newmont (NEM) | Barrick (B) | Agnico (AEM) |
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |

| | (KGC) | (NEM) | (B) | (AEM) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Cost / oz** | Rising ~40% | **$1,029** | Down 4% YoY | Premium tier |
| **Production** | 490K oz Q1 | **5.3M oz target** | Large scale | 825K oz Q1 |
| **Quarterly Profit** | $0.19 EPS | **$3.3B** | Up 238% | $1.7B |
| **Buybacks** | – | **$6B new** | $3B | Div. raised |
| **Net Cash** | – | **$3.1B FCF** | – | $2.9B |
| **Profile** | High beta | **Low-cost king** | Copper bonus | Steady |

**Market Briefs Pro**

*There's a catch, though.* Some of Barrick's biggest mines sit in tricky spots like Mali, Congo, and Pakistan, where politics can choke production with little warning.

Moving on, Agnico Eagle (AEM) is the more slow and steady pick in this report.

Agnico Eagle also mines gold, based in Canada, but primarily works out of Mexico and Australia.

## Barrick Mining Corporation (B)


*Data via Briefs Terminal*

Rare earths are abundant in Australia, and political volatility is also lower, which could lead to steadier returns.

It has a low-beta, so it moves less than the others when markets get choppy.

- It earned $1.7 billion last quarter on more than 825,000 ounces of gold.

It holds nearly $2.9 billion in net cash - meaning more cash than debt - and has slowly raised its dividend over the past five years. The gold it sold fetched 68% more than a year earlier.

**What that means:** Agnico may provide steady returns to investors, but it's unlikely to grow at the same speed as the other opportunities in this report.

It doesn’t have the same level of cash or operations as the bigger players.

*Data via Briefs Terminal*

But for investors interested in gold mining, Agnico could be a potential opportunity to watch as it scales and gold demand continues to rise.

**Exit Trigger:** For Barrick, keep an eye on copper - if copper prices crash in a recession, it would sting more than the pure gold names.

For Agnico, it's currently trading at a premium price compared to the other miners in this report.

If its costs rise or its cash pile shrinks, that could stall its growth, the investment opportunity with it.

---

***ETFS***

# Passive Plays Into Gold

For passive investors looking to capitalize on this shift, there are a few ETFs available:

- RING holds a wide basket of gold miners at one of the lowest fees around, and it's up more than 50% over the past year.

- SGDM picks miners based on financial strength instead of just size, and it's up about 11% so far this year.

- GDXJ owns smaller, riskier miners - it rocketed 178% in 2025, then slipped early this year.

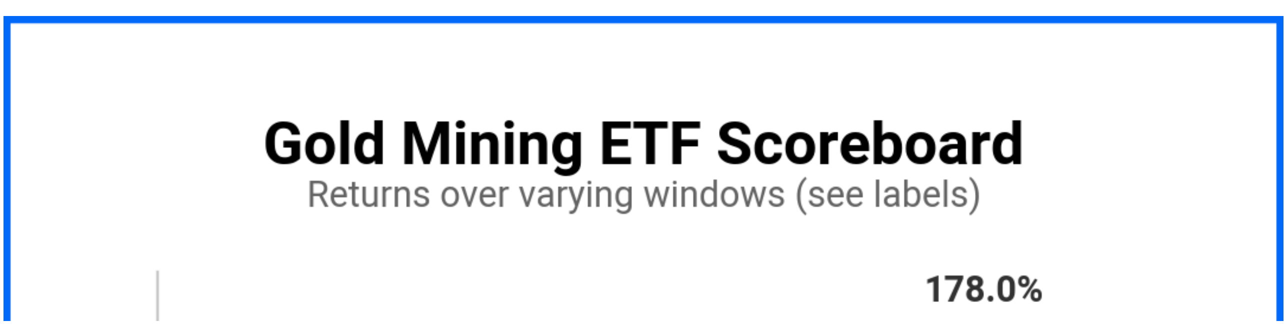
GDXJ spreads your money across roughly 100 small miners, so one bad mine won't sink it, but the whole basket still swings the most in both directions.

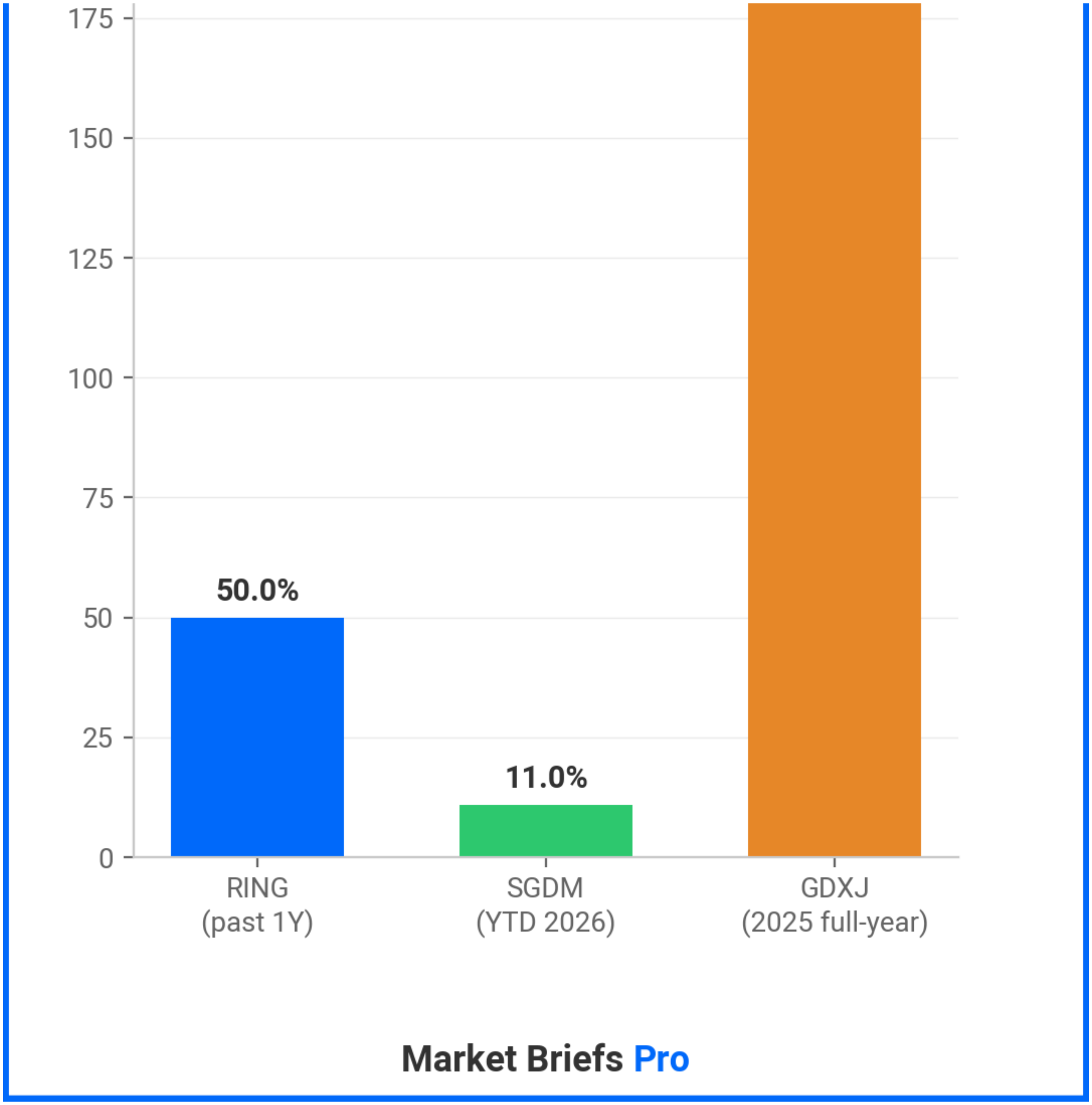

*Data via Briefs Terminal*

If gold takes off again, GDXJ could bounce back hard - just keep the slice small.

Many other funds trade in foreign markets that U.S. investors do not have easy access to.

But for the average passive investors, the opportunities above give exposure to the gold mining sector as a whole, without picking an individual stock.






---

*RISKS*

## How This Shift Could Change

The biggest risk? *History*. Back in 2007, these same 30-year bond rates touched 5% right before a major recession.

When that crash arrived, gold actually fell about 30% first - before it eventually soared.

So even if we're right over the long haul, there could be a sharp drop along the way.

There's also a chance the Middle East war suddenly ends, inflation cools quickly, and investors pile back into regular stocks.

If that plays out, gold could slide toward $4,000 before finding a floor.

---

***REVIEW***

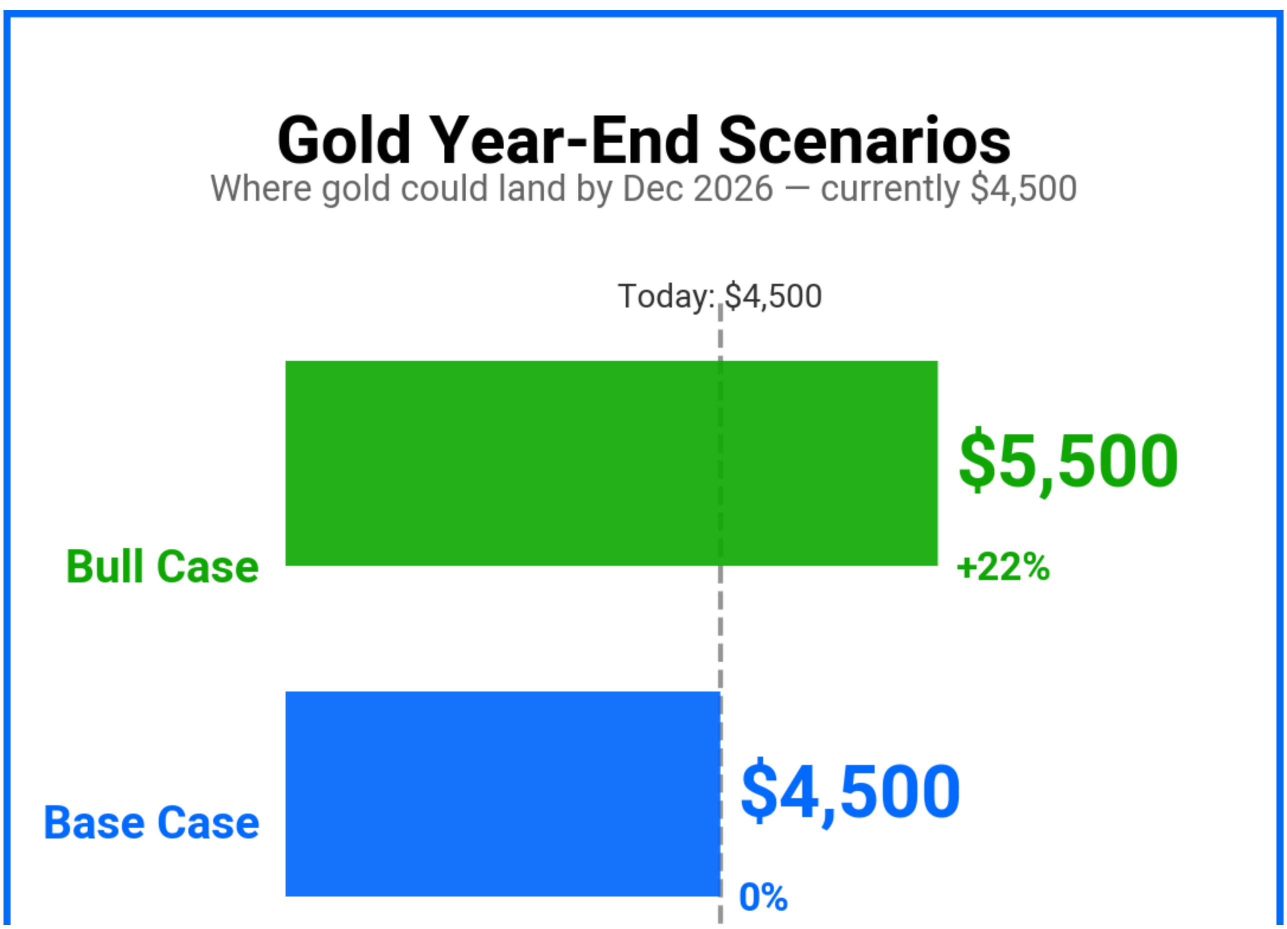
# Gold Is Still Shining

The short version: Gold is in a dip right now, but the shift we called 9 months ago is nowhere near over.

- Governments keep buying.
- The dollar keeps sliding.
- Miners keep minting money as gold outruns their costs.

Our own base case has gold near $5,500 by year-end - roughly 20% above today - though no one can promise where it lands.

Our updated game plan is simple - keep the names you already hold, make Newmont a new anchor, and quit trying to nail the exact bottom.




**Bull Case:** Central banks keep stacking; Fed cuts; Iran conflict drags on.
**Base Case:** Today's level holds as Wall Street digests the pullback.
**Bear Case:** Iran war ends; inflation cools; money rotates back to stocks.

**Market Briefs Pro**

Three things will tell us how the rest of the year unfolds:

Whether the Fed cuts rates in September, whether the Iran conflict settles or flares, and whether central banks keep stacking gold.

Gold may well dip again before it climbs.

But for patient investors, the mine still looks like it has plenty left to give and now could be an opportunity to get in before prices go back up.

**- Market Briefs Pro Team**

To manage your subscription, click here.
*The Market Briefs Pro team often invests in the same stocks and assets we cover.

**Why?** Because we believe in practicing what we preach (and preaching what we practice).

**But keep in mind:** We're not financial advisors. Everything we provide is for education. You've got to do your own due diligence and think about what makes sense for your own financial situation. Investing has risks.

You are never guaranteed to make money when you invest, you might even lose money. If you're looking for personalized financial advice, we highly recommend speaking with a licensed financial advisor.

**Our mission?** It's simple - to help you be better with money.

Included interviews have been edited for length and clarity.